"My suffering is meaningless."

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Where it often comes from

Pain without explanation can feel pointless, and nothing seems to come from it. The inability to see any good makes it worse.

What Scripture teaches

"We also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope." "We know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose." "After you have suffered for a little while, the God of all grace… will Himself restore you, secure you, strengthen you, and establish you." We may not see the reason now, but meaning can be found: comfort for others, deeper trust, and hope of restoration. "So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen."

> *"Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope. And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out His love into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, whom He has given us"* (Romans 5:3–5).

Also see

> "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose" (Romans 8:28).

> "And after you have suffered for a little while, the God of all grace, who has called you to His eternal glory in Christ, will Himself restore you, secure you, strengthen you, and establish you" (1 Peter 5:10).

> "So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen. For what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal" (2 Corinthians 4:18).

> "Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God" (2 Corinthians 1:3–4).

Common self-statements

- It is all for nothing.
- There is no point.
- I get nothing out of this.
- God wastes my pain.
- No good will come.
- It is senseless.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing suffering is either useful or meaningless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no good will come.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling pain and concluding that it is pointless.
- Labeling: Calling my suffering meaningless.

Challenging questions

- What have I learned or become through this, even small things?
- Whom has my suffering made me more sensitive to?
- What does Scripture say about God's purposes?
- What good could God bring, even if I cannot see it?
- What would it mean to wait for meaning?
- How could I use what I am learning to help someone?

Truth summary

> God can bring meaning from suffering, and nothing is wasted in His hands. I may not see it now, but I can look for growth, comfort for others, and hope of restoration.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Hardship
- Hopeless
- Faith
- Will of God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My suffering is meaningless"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My suffering is meaningless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I learned or become through this, even small things?
- ☐ Whom has my suffering made me more sensitive to?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's purposes?
- ☐ What good could God bring, even if I cannot see it?
- ☐ What would it mean to wait for meaning?
- ☐ How could I use what I am learning to help someone?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Suffering produces perseverance and hope.
- ☐ God works all things for good.
- ☐ God will restore me.
- ☐ He comforts me so I can comfort others.
- ☐ Nothing is wasted.
- ☐ Hope does not disappoint.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 5:3–5**
  "Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope. And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out His love into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, whom He has given us."
- ☐ **Romans 8:28**
  "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose."
- ☐ **1 Peter 5:10**
  "And after you have suffered for a little while, the God of all grace, who has called you to His eternal glory in Christ, will Himself restore you, secure you, strengthen you, and establish you."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Meaning found: Each month, note one thing suffering has taught you.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Romans 5:3–5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Suffering produces perseverance, character, and hope.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List what you learned. Write the changes in you.
- ☐ Comfort someone. Use your experience to encourage another.
- ☐ Wait with hope. Read Romans 5:3–5 daily.
- ☐ Talk with a pastor. Explore meaning together.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My suffering is meaningless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Meaning found
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My suffering is meaningless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I cannot see the meaning in this. Bring good from my pain, use me to comfort others, and hold me in hope. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.